



A changing world

At the beginning of the age of the dinosaurs, Earth's continents (areas of land) were joined together as one big supercontinent called **Pangaea**.

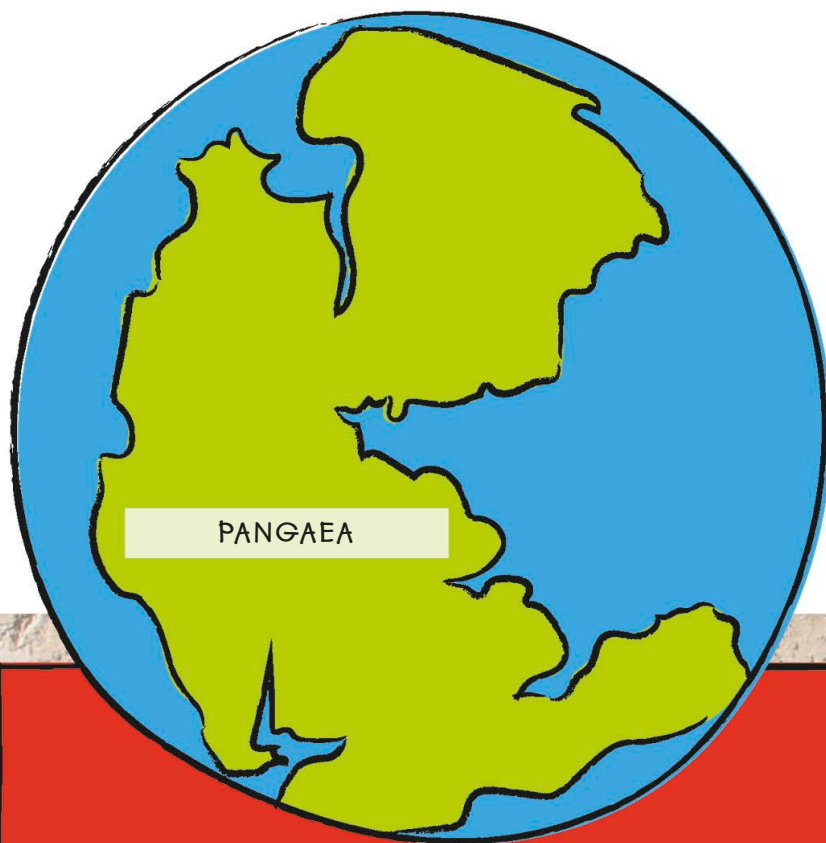
But over millions of years the continents split apart.



The word Pangaea means "All Earth".

Why they move

Continents move because **tectonic plates** (huge slabs of rock deep within the Earth) are slowly pushed around by the liquid rock beneath them.



251 million years ago...

At the beginning of the **Triassic**, all of Earth's continents were joined together in a C-shaped land mass called Pangaea.